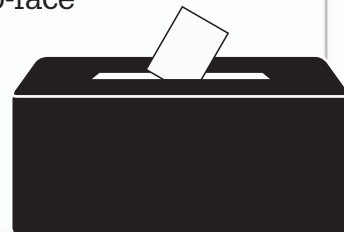




POLITICIAN

JOB DESCRIPTION

Politicians are public servants elected by voters to make decisions that shape society and affect their communities on all levels—local, state, and national. They aim to improve citizens' lives by pressing for changes in society and the laws that govern it. In this role, you will hold face-to-face sessions in your community, debate and vote on issues, and campaign for yourself and your political party.



SALARY

Political aide ★★☆☆☆
Politicians' salaries vary

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Entry into the field is competitive • Opportunities to work at a local, state, and/or national level • Career prospects and pay rates vary depending on the role

CAREER PATHS

Entry into—and advancement within—this career is largely down to self-motivation. Some politicians work in local government, while others represent their voters at the state or national levels. In politics, perhaps even more so than in other fields, career paths vary according to the type of politician you want to be.

NON-GRADUATE You can run for office as long as you meet certain basic qualifications, such as age and residency.

GRADUATE You can earn a degree in political science or public administration. Experience working for political campaigns or interning with an elected official's office is helpful.

LAWYER Though it is not a requirement, many politicians at the higher levels of government hold law degrees.



DIPLOMAT Represents the United States in foreign affairs. Job responsibilities vary from negotiating treaties to managing staff at an overseas embassy.



POLITICIAN As a politician, you work at every level of government, from town council membership all the way up to the presidency. Once elected, you can choose to focus on specific areas of policy. There are a vast amount of career options and specializations for you to choose from.